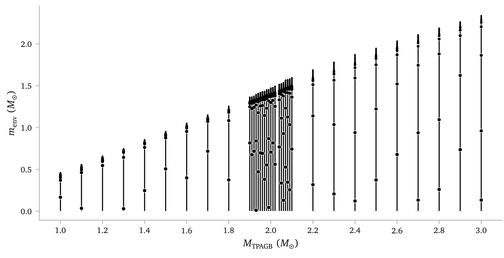
Koen Essers • Master Internship • November 11, 2026

Notes Week 36

a. Dense Mass Spacing Results

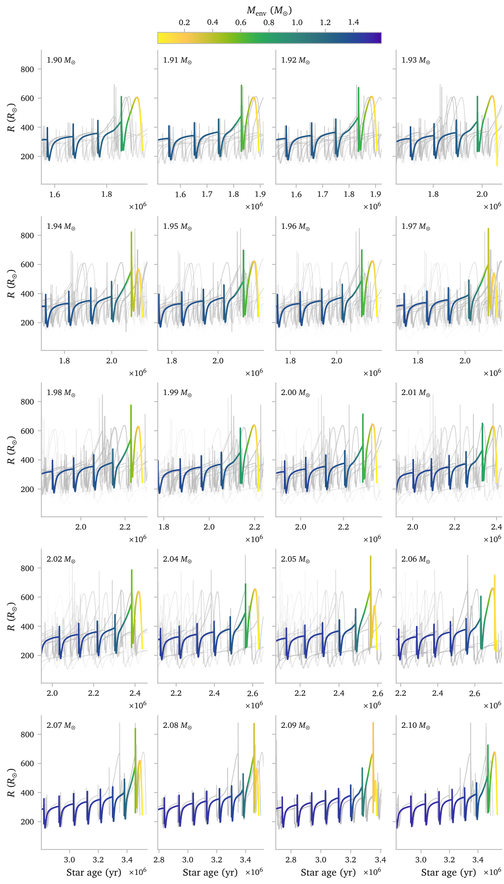
Below I plot the envelope mass for the new models and the old ones.



Quite clearly, even for 0.01 $M_\odot$ differences in mass, there is no predictable relation between changes in initial mass and envelope mass during the last thermal pulse.

It seems to be very "chaotic". Small perturbations in initial mass lead to quite drastically different final TPAGB evolutions.

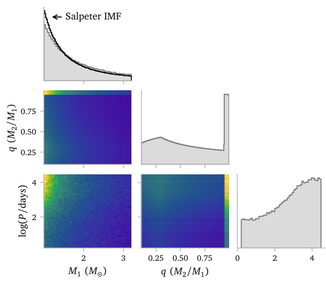
To highlight this, let me show the last few thermal pulses for the different masses between 1.9 $M_\odot$ and 2.1 $M_\odot$.



b. Moe and Di Stefano

I use a standard Salpeter (1955) IMF. Differences between this IMF and for example, Chabrier (2003) should be very minor, since we are only interested in primaries that produce enough s-process elements in third dredge-up episodes. This happens at masses of about 1.2 $M_\odot$ and higher. We also only go up to masses of $M = 3.0$ $M_\odot$. Above this mass, it is difficult to reproduce barium dwarfs with masses within the observed range. Therefore, I have not simulated these TPAGB stars with MESA for masses above 3.0 $M_\odot$.

For the plots below, I only show periods below 30 000 days, because periods above this limit will not produce barium dwarfs within the observed period range, and *definitely* not RLOF TPAGB binaries.

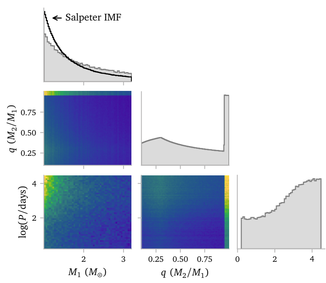


Here, I show a population of 153714(000) *binaries* using the parameterization of Moe & Di Stefano (2017). Their paper explicitly describes multiplicities, and not only binaries, so really I generated a bunch of singles, binaries, triples and quadruples, but I only show the binaries here.

Clearly, the mass distribution is similar to the Salpeter (1955) IMF. However, it is slightly flatter. There are slightly more heavier stars and slightly fewer lighter stars.

The binaries also contain many "twin" binaries. This is about 10 to 15% of the total systems.

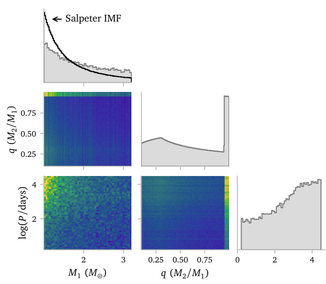
Lastly, we see that, in log space, there are many more wide orbits. However, if you would look at the systems in linear space, the peak is towards lower periods.



Here, I show the same distributions, but now for the population containing 91111(000) triples.

There are fewer triples, which is to be expected within this mass range. Let me be fully clear on what I do with the triples as well as the quadruples. Triples contain two binaries. I simply include none, one, or both of these orbits, only dependent on if they are within the period range. This means the fraction of triple *orbits* over binary *orbits* will be *larger* than the fraction of triple *systems* over binary *systems*.

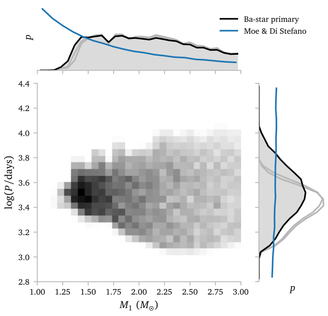
The mass-ratio distribution and period distributions are not very different. However, we see a much shallower IMF.



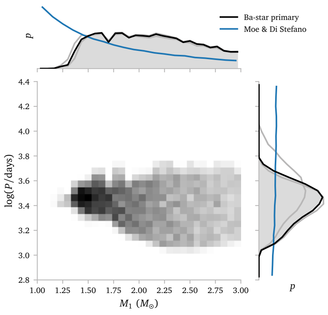
Here, I show the same distributions, but now for the population containing 27730(000) triples.

The mass-ratio distribution and period distributions are not very different. However, we see a much shallower IMF, even shallower than for the triples.

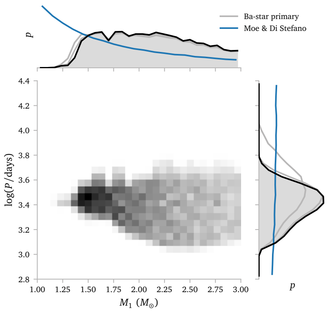
Moe & Di Stefano Binary population with Saladino Winds



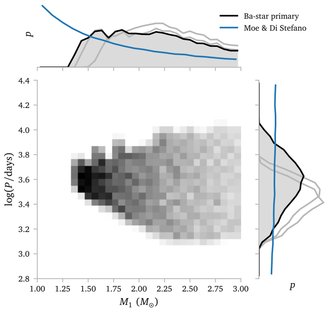
Moe & Di Stefano Binary population with BHL Winds



Moe & Di Stefano Binary population with fast Winds

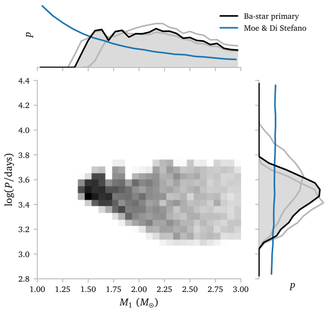


Moe & Di Stefano Binary population with Saladino Winds

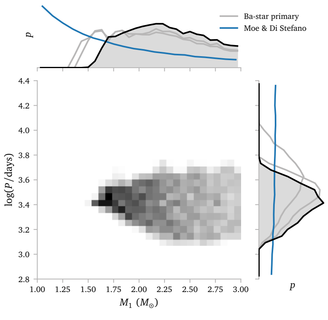


If we require the binaries to have $q > 0.5$ for stable mass transfer, we get slightly different distributions. Here I also increased the barium threshold to $[s/Fe] > 0.5$.

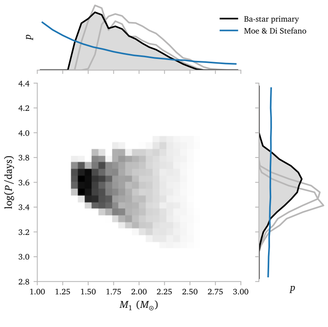
Moe & Di Stefano Binary population with BHL Winds



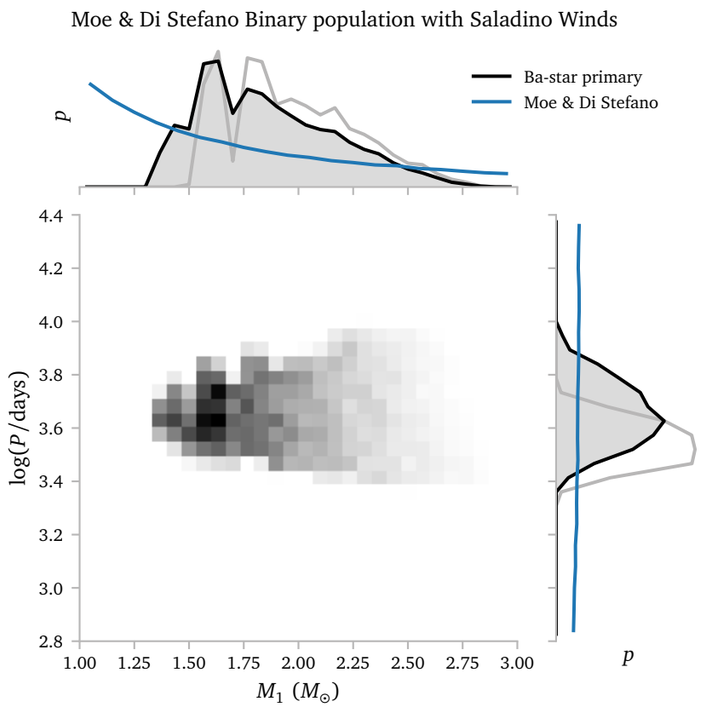
Moe & Di Stefano Binary population with fast Winds



Moe & Di Stefano Binary population with Saladino Winds



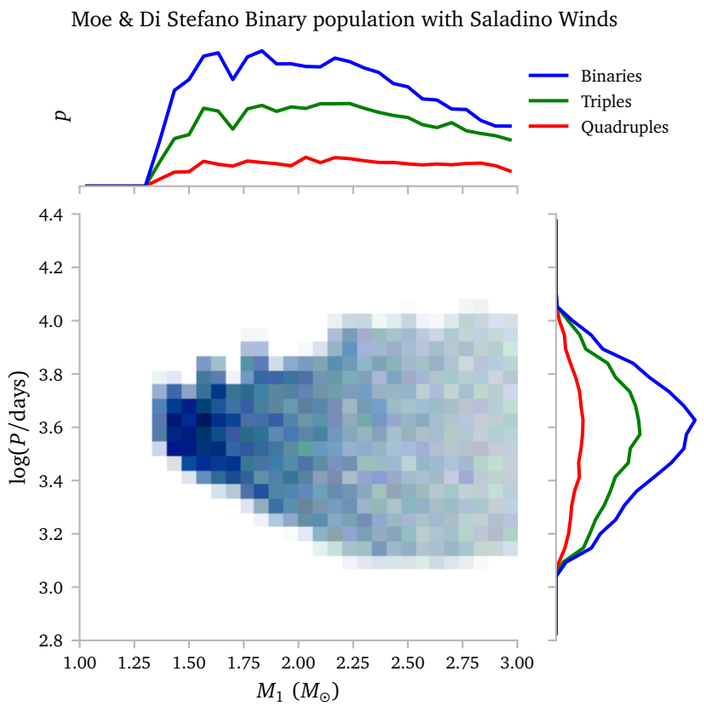
$\varepsilon = 0.1$

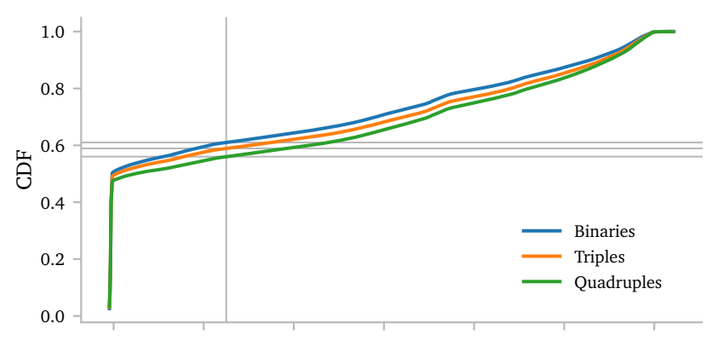


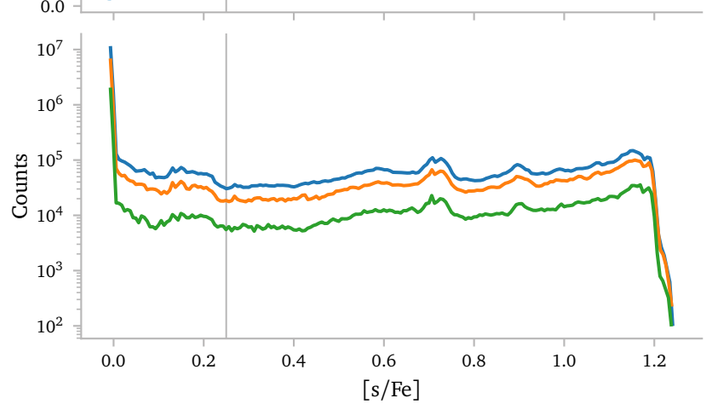
$\varepsilon = 0.0$

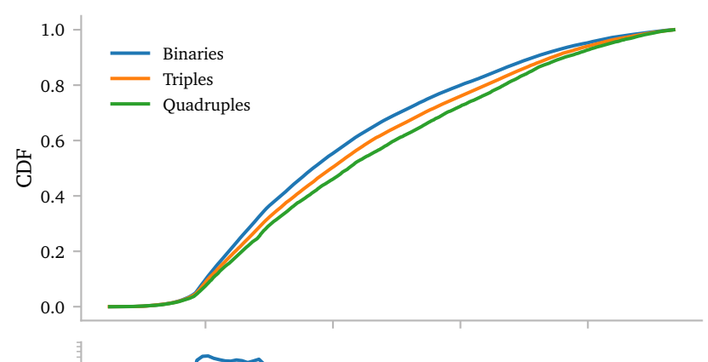
The fast winds models cannot produce barium stars. This is simply because we *only* have wind mass transfer, and the fast winds do not transfer mass.

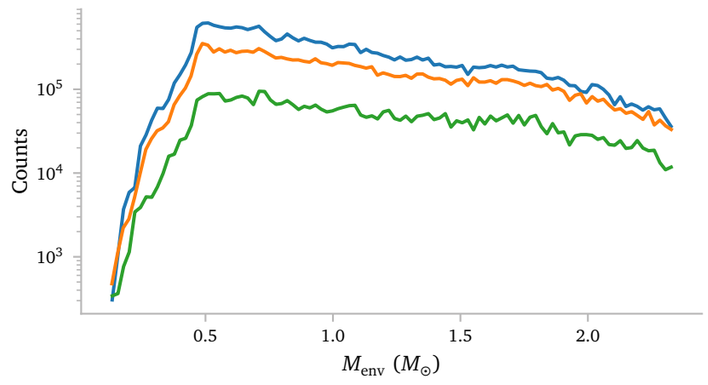
For the Saladino winds, we also see that the lower initial periods are now missing. This is because these models do not experience wind before RLOF occurs. In the simple case explored here, mass is stripped in its entirety during RLOF. However, we have seen that this is not very realistic. Therefore, the plot above is probably much more relevant.

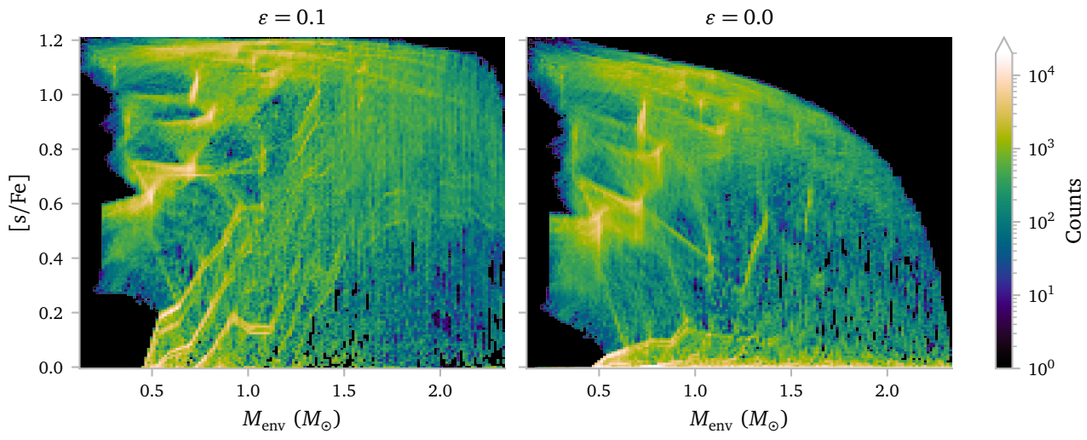


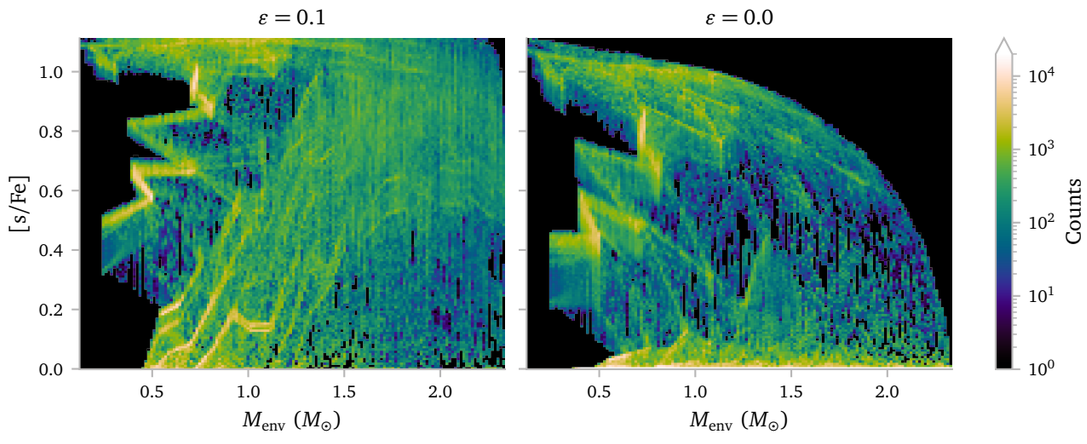


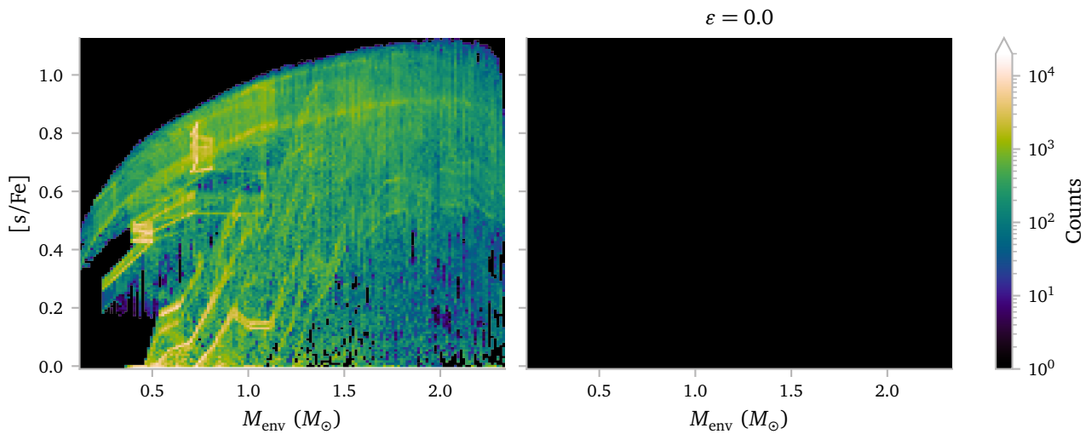


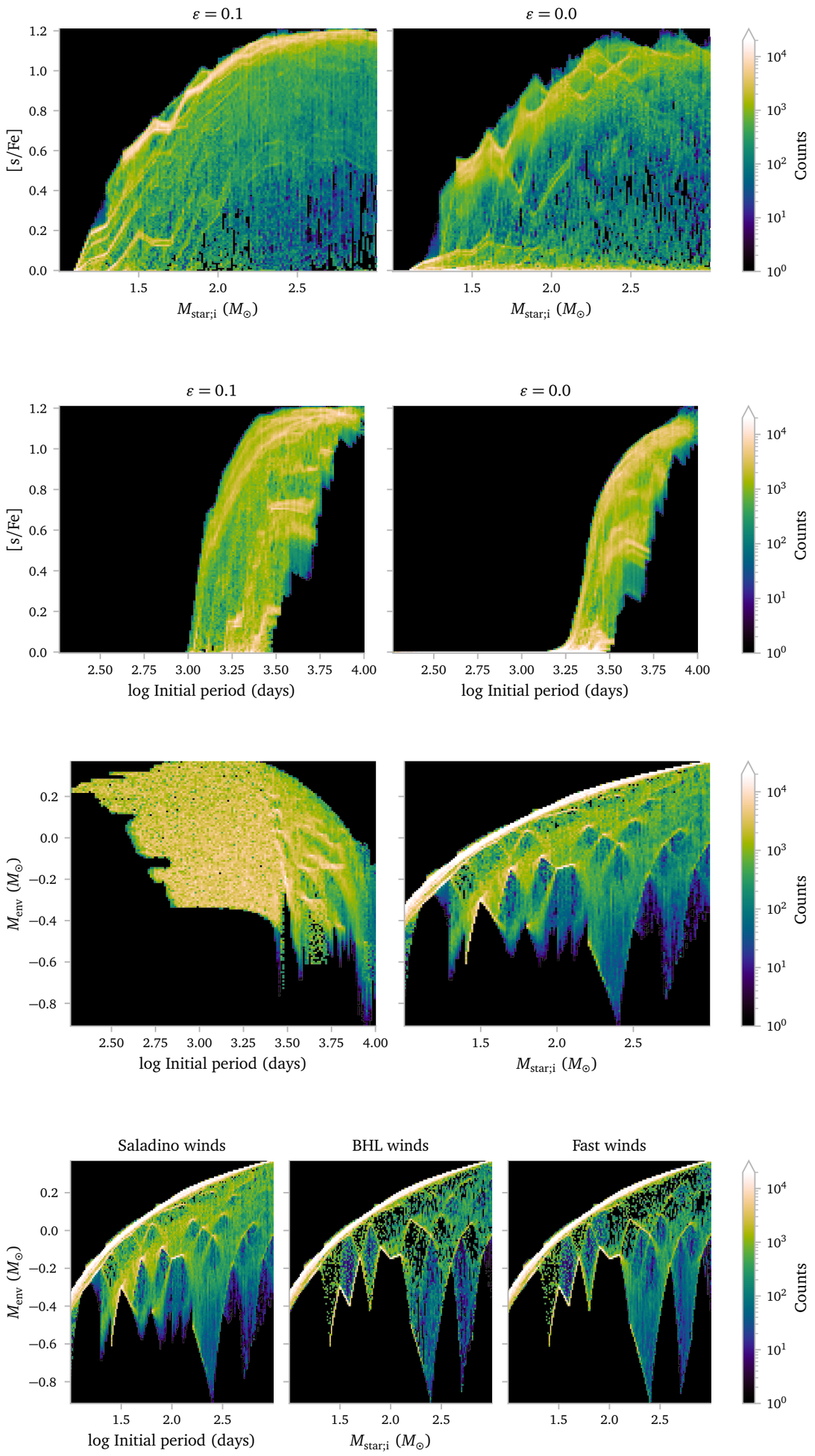












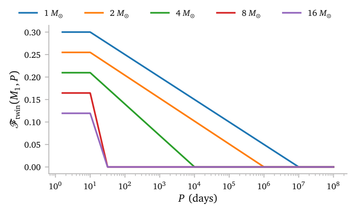
References

Chabrier, G. (2003) *Galactic Stellar and Substellar Initial Mass Function*. PASP115, 763.

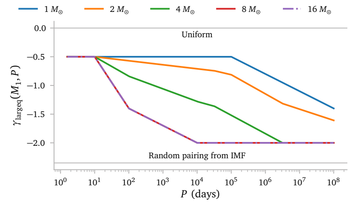
Moe, M. & Di Stefano, R. (2017) *Mind Your Ps and Qs: The Interrelation between Period (P) and Mass-ratio (Q) Distributions of Binary Stars*. ApJS230, 15.

Salpeter, E. E. (1955) *The Luminosity Function and Stellar Evolution.*. ApJ121, 161.

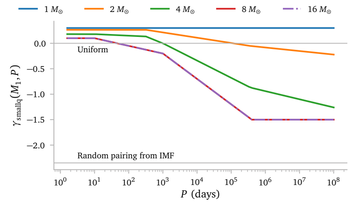
A Moe and Di Stefano Tests



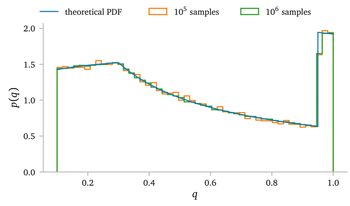
Compared with Figure 35 from Moe & Di Stefano (2017), these results look sensible.



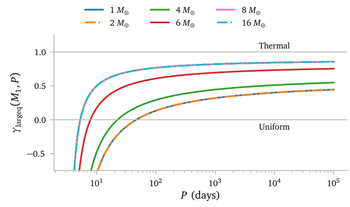
Compared with Figure 35 from Moe & Di Stefano (2017), these results look sensible.



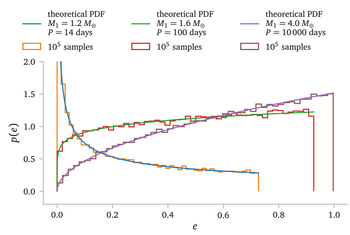
Compared with Figure 35 from Moe & Di Stefano (2017), these results look sensible.



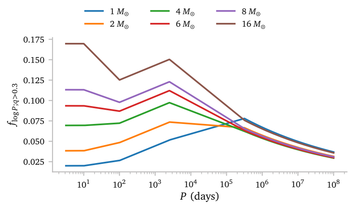
Compared with Figure 2 from Moe & Di Stefano (2017), these results look sensible.



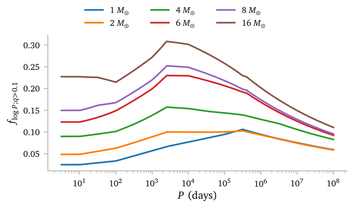
Compared with Figure 36 from Moe & Di Stefano (2017), these results look sensible.



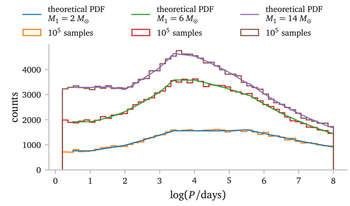
Based on how power laws should look and the figure above, I think this makes sense.



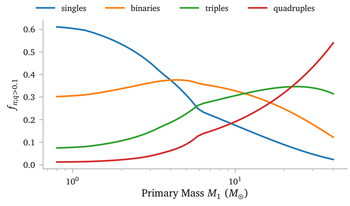
Compared with Figure 37 from Moe & Di Stefano (2017), these results look sensible.



Compared with Figure 37 from Moe & Di Stefano (2017), these results look sensible.

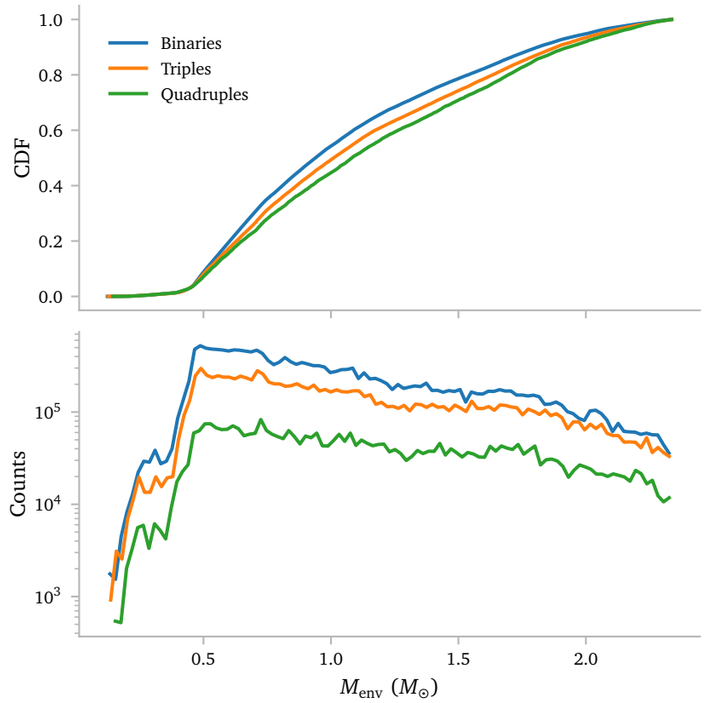


Sampling reproduces the period frequencies well.

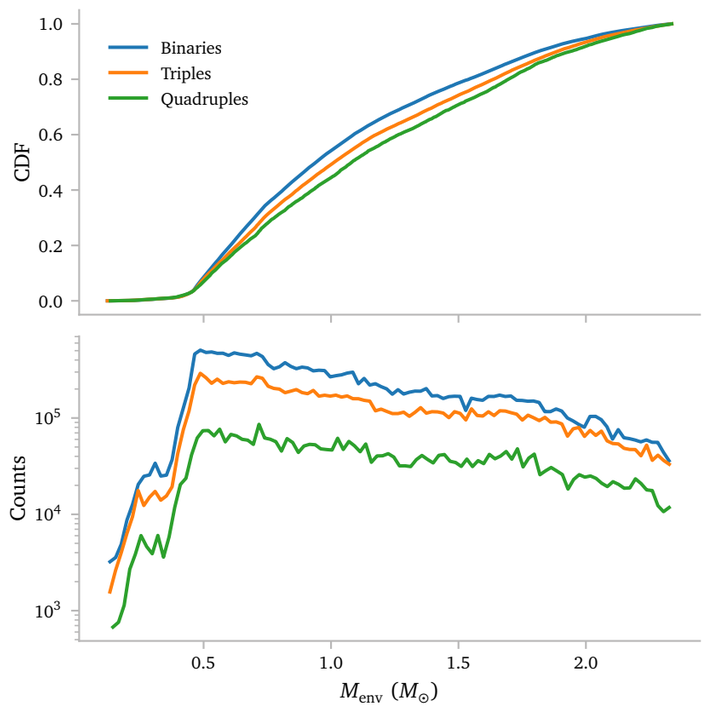


Compared with Figure 39 from Moe & Di Stefano (2017), these results look sensible.

B Additional Plots



Binaries, $\varepsilon = 0.1$, BHL



Binaries, $\varepsilon = 0.1$, fast